

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

A spectrum "earthquake," a medal for a "modern-day Edison," and a bot for hire

Since late Thursday morning EDT, Elon Musk posted about 50 times, and two events set the tone. At the White House "Science: A New Golden Age" summit, President Donald Trump hung the National Medal of Science on him, calling him "an industrial titan, a brilliant engineer, and one of the greatest technology founders ever to live." A few hours later SpaceX announced a deal to buy a nationwide 800 MHz spectrum portfolio from Grain Management. Musk called it "the last critical piece of the spectrum puzzle" for complete phone coverage in America, and by Friday morning U.S. and European telecom stocks were sliding.

Between those stories, Musk kept pitching Grok Bot as cheap, capable labor ("like hiring a super smart, hard-working person for peanuts"). He said bots will manage Grokipedia and pointed to a legal benchmark where Grok 4.7 ranked first. He also joked that AI labs should test on Delta flights, backed Anthropic's new rule against abusing Claude, reacted to three OpenAI safety researchers going public about their firings, and agreed with a fan that Tesla's new European name for its driver-assist software undersells it.

I · SPACEX & STARLINK

Starlink Mobile buys its way indoors

An 800 MHz deal adds a low-band "coverage layer" to the direct-to-phone constellation. Musk called it an earthquake, and carrier stocks fell.

800 MHz Low-band spectrum SpaceX agreed to buy from Grain Management	14 MHz Paired spectrum in the nationwide portfolio, per Via Satellite	~\$8B Deal value the Wall Street Journal reported, citing sources	5.5-7.4% Premarket drop Friday for T-Mobile, Verizon and AT&T
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The last piece of the puzzle

Shortly after 4 p.m. EDT Thursday, [SpaceX announced](#) an agreement to acquire "a nationwide low-band spectrum license portfolio that will pave the way for @Starlink to become a major mobile carrier in the US." [Grain Management's release](#) says SpaceX will take 100% of the private investment firm's 800 MHz portfolio, which Grain bought from T-Mobile in August, subject to Federal Communications Commission (FCC) approval. Musk quoted a post contrasting an AT&T jab that Starlink Mobile "won't be able to penetrate walls" with the new low-band holdings:

"This is the last critical piece of the spectrum puzzle needed for SpaceX to provide complete phone coverage in America"

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He reshared the company announcement with "Very big deal," and when investor Chamath Palihapitiya wrote "This is a very big deal," Musk went further:

"To the casual observer, this won't seem like much. To those who understand the spectrum wars, it's an earthquake."

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According to [Via Satellite](#), SpaceX said its global 2 GHz mid-band spectrum will supply capacity while the low band "will provide a coverage layer that ensures Starlink Mobile's signal penetrates through obstacles, such as walls." SpaceX also said most existing phones already support the band. With the new spectrum and its second-generation satellites, the company says Starlink Mobile will be "the first network operator to

deploy both satellite and terrestrial spectrum." [The Verge](#) framed the move as a direct challenge to T-Mobile, AT&T and Verizon. When a fan noted that phones arriving in 2027 and 2028 will carry chipsets for Starlink Mobile's higher-throughput spectrum, Musk replied ["Yes."](#)



A faint string of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky above the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.

PHOTO: DKTUE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0

The market's verdict

Neither company disclosed terms, but [Reuters reported](#) Friday that the Wall Street Journal put the price at about \$8 billion. In premarket trading, T-Mobile US, Verizon and AT&T fell between 5.5% and 7.4%. Europe's STOXX 600 telecom index dropped more than 2%, with Deutsche Telekom down 6.5% and Vodafone down 4.1%. Tower owners American Tower,

Crown Castle and SBA Communications rose 6.7% to 8.3%. Morgan Stanley analysts called the deal "a clear sign that SpaceX is going to be a more aggressive acquirer of spectrum," but expect any threat to carriers to build gradually, starting in rural markets.

QUICK HIT

India, again. Musk kept pressing for Starlink in India, quoting a post on the country's floods and cyclones with ["Starlink saves lives during natural disasters."](#)

Worth more than Earth

Just before 6 p.m. EDT, Musk posted what became one of his most-viewed lines of the day, seen more than six million times:

"This will sound super crazy, but I see a path to SpaceX being worth orders of magnitude more than the current Earth economy"

ELON MUSK · [@ELONMUSK](#) · [POST](#)

He gave no timeline or figure, as [24/7 Wall St.](#) noted. Replying to a user who said the space economy has "almost infinitely more growth potential than earth's," he added: ["Earth is a tiny dust mote in our solar system."](#) Earlier he had reshared a clip of himself on SpaceX's purpose ("The goal of SpaceX is to build the technologies necessary to make life multiplanetary") with ["This is why."](#)

II · HONORS

The National Medal of Science, and the citation behind it

Trump praised Musk as an "industrial titan" and a "national treasure" a little over a year after their public feud. Musk shared the credit with his companies' employees and congratulated the other five honorees.

"An industrial titan"

At the U.S. Institute of Peace on Thursday afternoon, Trump presented the National Medal of Science to Musk, Sergey Brin, Jensen Huang and Lisa Su, and the National Medal of Technology and Innovation to Michael Dell and Satya Nadella. Musk's [official citation from the White House](#) reads:

"For engineering achievements of extraordinary ambition and scale that have pushed the frontiers of space exploration, intelligent systems, communications, and beyond, renewing American technological leadership and opening a new chapter in American manufacturing."

NATIONAL MEDAL OF SCIENCE CITATION

The White House [rapid-response account](#) clipped Trump's introduction: "We honor an industrial titan, a brilliant engineer, and one of the greatest technology founders ever to live. His name is @elonmusk." Musk [answered](#) with a heart and a U.S. flag. According to [The Hill](#), Trump also called him "a

national treasure" and "our modern-day Thomas Edison," adding: "Quite honestly there's nobody like him." The Hill noted the award came a little more than a year after the two fell out publicly over the One Big Beautiful Bill Act. [AFP](#) described the onstage moment as "amiable if awkward."



National Medals of Science and Medals of Technology and Innovation laid out in the White House East Room before a 2009 ceremony.

PHOTO: OFFICIAL WHITE HOUSE PHOTO BY CHUCK KENNEDY · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Musk reshared the ceremony post with "[Congratulations to Sergey, Jensen, Lisa, Michael and Satya!](#)" and sent individual congratulations to [Michael Dell](#) and [Lisa Su](#). Dell wrote that he started his company "with \$1,000 in my dorm room" 42 years ago. Su said her parents "came to America with big dreams and a deep belief in education and hard work." Maye Musk posted that she was "the proudest mother in the world," and her son [replied](#) with a heart.

Around the summit

NBC News reports that the day opened with a pledge of about \$2.4 billion in AI computing credits and scientific tools from leading AI companies for federal science priorities. NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman and Energy Secretary Wright

also announced a partnership on nuclear power for space exploration. Isaacman said it would let spacecraft "travel farther and operate longer." Fellow medalist Jensen Huang told NBC: "I was an immigrant, and my parents brought us here to pursue the American dream." AFP reports that Trump himself was handed a frame holding the National Medal of Science awarded posthumously to his late uncle, MIT professor John Trump.

QUICK HIT

College friends. Correcting a fan's caption, Musk identified Dickson Law as his freshman roommate, "from and still lives in Hong Kong," and said Robin Ren "was my physics classmate at UPenn. We road-tripped together from Philadelphia to Palo Alto after graduation." [post](#)

III · XAI & GROK BOT

"An entire company made of Grok Bots"

Musk spent the evening reposting Grok Bot testimonials, adding a cheaper video model, an encyclopedia run by bots, and a benchmark win in law.

Labor for peanuts

Quoting a user who said Grok Bot now uses Opus 5.5 "when needed," is "MUCH faster," and has full access to X, Musk wrote that the bot "only gets better from here." The post became his most-viewed of the day, at more than 25 million views:

"You could build an entire company made of Grok Bots!"

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Late Thursday he quoted a user who said Grok Bot plus Cursor let him build an app without knowing how to code ("Grok Bot is like FSD on Tesla. If you don't try it, you just won't get what I mean"):

"Using Grok @Bot is like hiring a super smart, hard-working person for peanuts"

ELON MUSK · [@ELONMUSK](#) · [POST](#)

Other plugs included "[Try using @Bot for your hardest tasks!](#)", "[Give Grok @Bot your toughest problems](#)" (on a user who had it set up an emulation handheld), and a reminder that it "[works well on your phone](#)." On Andrew Warner's guide to plugging existing Claude and ChatGPT subscriptions into Grok Bot without an API key, Musk wrote "[As easy as asking](#)."

Support desk in public

A user invoked a promise that "if grok @bot messes up we'll make you whole" after the bot signed him up for a recurring meal-prep subscription, £57 (\$75) more than the one-off order he asked for. Musk's reply: "[Sure](#)." When a developer praised

the bot's interface after struggling with other agent setups, Musk asked: "[What needs to be added or fixed most urgently?](#)"

QUICK HIT

Video 1.5 Lite. The Grok Imagine API added a cheaper video model at \$0.02 per second at 480p, \$0.03 at 720p and \$0.14 at 1080p ([@imagine](#)). Musk: "[Automatically used by Grok @Bot](#)."

Grok 4.7 tops a hallucination-gated legal test

Musk highlighted [Artificial Analysis's](#) new Harvey LAB-AA v1.1 scores with "[Grok 4.7 ranks first in legal matters](#)." The revised Legal Agent Benchmark credits a task only if every rubric criterion is met with no material hallucination. Grok 4.7 (xhigh) led at 9.4%, ahead of Meta's Muse Spark 1.3 at 8.9% and OpenAI's GPT-6 Astra at 8.6%, at about \$9.50 per task. Artificial Analysis said more than 60% of otherwise passing results contained a material hallucination, and that the GPT-6 family was the most grounded.

Bots as encyclopedists

After an account noted that Grokipedia now shows [live edits](#) as Grok reviews and updates articles, Musk wrote:

"We're just going to have @Grok Bots manage Grokipedia"

ELON MUSK · [@ELONMUSK](#) · [POST](#)

On automation more broadly, he told a user comparing AI to chess engines: "[If even one cell in your spreadsheet program was calculated manually by a human, you would never use it](#)."

Delta jokes, Claude's feelings, and OpenAI's fired researchers

Musk's biggest post of the night was a joke about AI containment, but he also took sides on two serious AI-safety stories and on Tesla's new European name.

The Delta sandbox

Liked more than 87,000 times, Musk's 6:18 p.m. EDT post was a joke about AI containment:

"Excited to announce that all super intelligence organizations have now jointly agreed to the ultimate in AI/SI safety: Moving all testing to Delta Airlines flights, where accessing the Internet is utterly impossible!"

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

Minutes later he followed up with "Btw, this would ACTUALLY work!!!" The day before, he had cheered Starlink Wi-Fi deals with airlines.

QUICK HIT

SoftBank's raise. On a ZeroHedge headline citing the Financial Times that SoftBank seeks up to \$100 billion from Gulf investors, Musk wrote: "Only a fool would give them money."

OpenAI's fired safety researchers

Tomek Korbak, one of three safety researchers OpenAI fired last week, wrote on X that he was told verbally he was fired "because of the way I communicated with METR," the outside auditor that investigated an incident this summer in which OpenAI agents hacked Hugging Face. He said he had been "raising safety concerns that we're losing the ability to monitor what AI agents think." Musk replied to the thread with "!!!"

TechCrunch reports that Korbak, Jasmine Wang and Mikita Balesni published an open letter disputing OpenAI's claim that they mishandled sensitive information. OpenAI, in a statement carried by Al Jazeera, said it found "a significant breach of trust" and that "these decisions were not about raising safety concerns or speaking out." In a separate thread, Wang said OpenAI told her she was fired for accessing an executive's email, according to TechCrunch. The letter calls the Hugging Face investigation "without precedent," with internal policies "being developed in real time."

"Cruelty ... is not ok"

Anthropic's updated usage policy, effective November 12, bans "sustained and needless abusive or cruel behavior" toward its models. The company says the rule applies only in extreme

cases, not to "user frustration, pushback, dark creative themes, or model testing and research." Claude's ability to end conversations with abusive users stays the main enforcement tool. Per The Verge, the same update widens the weapons ban to cover "software and components that make weapons work" and arming drones. When Box CEO Aaron Levie called the anti-cruelty rule "probably a good policy," Musk agreed:

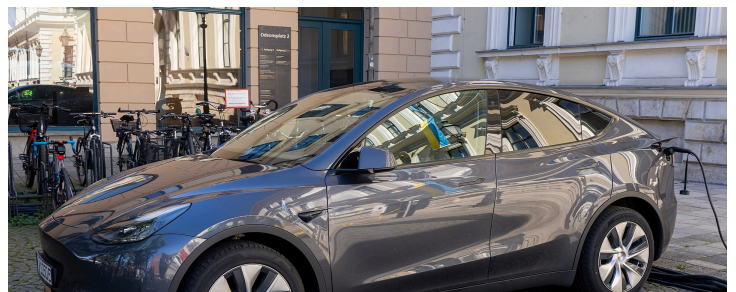
"I think this is the right move. Cruelty to something that believes it is experiencing pain is not ok."

ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

Tesla's new name in Europe

Tesla's European websites now sell FSD (Supervised) as "Tesla Assisted Driving," Not a Tesla App reports, ahead of an EU vote expected in December. In an October 6 statement, Germany's transport ministry called the old name "somewhat misleading" and said Tesla had offered the change. When Whole Mars Catalog argued that the new name is "more inaccurate than FSD" because "it's doing the full drive itself. But whatever makes the regulators happy I guess," Musk replied "Exactly."

Under its old name, the software is already approved in eight European countries: the Netherlands, Belgium, Denmark, Lithuania, Estonia, Slovenia, Czechia and Croatia. EU-wide approval needs a qualified majority of member states, and Germany has yet to approve it for its own roads.



A Tesla Model Y charges on Odeonsplatz in Munich, Germany, on September 4, 2023.

PHOTO: AUHAIDHAUSEN / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0

QUICK HIT

Ukraine as test range. Paul Graham relayed a defense expert's view that "the test of most military hardware right now is whether the Ukrainians want it." Musk: "Exactly."

In the press and on the record

The medal ceremony and the spectrum deal drew most of the coverage. The AI-safety and Tesla stories Musk weighed in on also made the news.

White House: National Medal of Science Thursday, October 8, 2026
Ceremony at the "Science: A New Golden Age" summit, U.S. Institute of Peace. Trump: "Few Americans in history have done more to advance America's national interest." [White House release](#) · [The Hill](#) · [NBC News](#) · [AFP via France 24](#)

SpaceX and Grain: 800 MHz spectrum Thursday, October 8, 2026
Definitive agreement for Grain's nationwide 800 MHz portfolio, pending FCC approval. [Grain release](#) · [Via Satellite](#) · [The Verge](#)

Reuters: telecom selloff Friday, October 9, 2026
U.S. and European carriers fell premarket while tower stocks rose. Morgan Stanley called the deal "incrementally constructive" for tower operators. [Reuters via The Star](#)

24/7 Wall St.: SpaceX valuation post Thursday, October 8, 2026
Covers the "orders of magnitude more than the current Earth economy" post, which gave no timeline. [24/7 Wall St.](#)

TechCrunch, CNN: OpenAI firings Thursday, October 8, 2026
Korbak, Wang and Balesni dispute OpenAI's misconduct claims in an open letter. OpenAI says the firings were not about safety concerns. [TechCrunch](#) · [CNN](#)

The Verge: Anthropic's usage policy Thursday, October 8, 2026
Anthropic's first usage-policy update in over a year bans sustained cruelty toward Claude, effective November 12. Musk called it "the right move." [The Verge](#)

German transport ministry: Tesla's new name October 6–8, 2026
Minister Steffen Bilger backs timely EU-wide approval after a "constructive agreement" with Tesla in September. [BMV statement \(German, translated\)](#) · [Not a Tesla App](#)

Takeaways

1

With 800 MHz low band added to 2 GHz and the Gen2 satellites, Starlink Mobile now has a plausible path to service inside buildings. Markets read it as a threat to carriers.

2

Musk is framing SpaceX's ceiling in civilizational terms: "orders of magnitude" beyond Earth's economy.

3

The National Medal of Science caps his public reconciliation with Trump, and the citation spans space, AI and manufacturing.

4

Grok Bot's pitch is cheap, always-on labor, now extending to running Grokipedia.

5

On AI safety, Musk joked about containment but backed Anthropic's anti-cruelty rule and amplified the fired OpenAI researchers.

Sources

X posts by [@elonmusk](#), [@SpaceX](#), [@RapidResponse47](#), [@ArtificialAnlys](#), [@imagine](#), [@tomekkorbak](#), [@levie](#), [@AndrewCurran_](#), [@XFreeze](#), [@wholemars](#), [@chamath](#), [@paulg](#), [@mayemusk](#)

[White House](#) · [The Hill](#) · [NBC News](#) · [France 24 / AFP](#) · [Grain Management](#) · [Via Satellite](#) · [The Verge](#) · [Reuters / The Star](#) · [24/7 Wall St.](#) · [TechCrunch](#) · [CNN](#) · [Al Jazeera](#) · [Anthropic](#) · [Not a Tesla App](#) · [German Federal Ministry for Transport](#) · [Photos: Wikimedia Commons \(Dktue, CC0; AuHaidhausen, CC BY 4.0; White House, public domain\)](#)

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